

share of 57.7 per cent, but are steadily losing their share. Dynamically-typed languages have a 42.3 per cent share—and are becoming more popular every year.

The Web is becoming more pervasive; naturally, languages that support Web programming are getting more popular. I didn't know that PHP was such a popular language and that, too, even more than C++!

Objective-C is as old as C++, but it is getting popular now, thanks to Apple. Apple uses this language heavily in its platforms like Mac OS and iPhone. For software development in these platforms, Objective-C is becoming a natural choice.

Scripting languages are clearly becoming more popular than ever before. Perl is slowly fading, but Python has steadily gained considerable popularity.

Tiobe does not consider HTML, XML, SQL, ASP, Cocoa, etc. as 'programming languages' because they are not languages but are often considered 'for data-querying', 'doing markups', or 'only technologies'. I would have liked including many of them in the list.

Except for C, languages lacking Garbage Collection support seem to be steadily losing popularity (C++, Fortran, COBOL, etc.).

The website www.langpop.com also collects data on language popularity. Unlike Tiobe, which gets data from search engine queries, this website collects data from various sources like books, amount of code contributed in open source projects, Google code, job search sites, etc. Take a look at the following table:

Source	Top three languages (in order)
Yahoo! Search	C, Java, PHP
Google code	C, Java, C++
Craigslist.org (job search website)	PHP, C, SQL
Powell's (a book seller)	Java, C++, Visual Basic
Freshmeat.net (applications)	C, Java, C++
Del.icio.us (social bookmarking)	JavaScript, Java, Python
ohloh.net (open source code)	C, Java, C++
Normalised comparison (combined result)	Java, C, C++

I just did my own analysis of best selling books on programming languages. In Amazon.com, I selected programming books in "Bestsellers > Books > Computers & Internet > Programming". I looked out for books only with the name of the language in the title (ignoring iPhone development, for example), and avoiding language independent books (like 'clean code'). Take a look at the following table:

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